

Winning the first conversation

67 minutes including practice · 16 screens

Edition 2026-09-12-live-v1

Before you begin

Eric opens Rep, selects the training and existing agents across teams, confirms the timezone, and creates the session. The creator is the default presenter and follow-up coach. Keep the private presenter console on your screen and share the separate presentation window.

Ask each selected agent to open the session through their own existing login. No second invitation is needed. Confirm that everyone can join and see the current activity. Submit written work before showing the model. Give one correction, then ask for a targeted retry. Open activities under presenter control; advancing leaves unfinished work available for catch-up. Show help requests and connection problems separately.

In self-paced study, notes remain in the learner's browser until they choose to share them. In a live session, the presenter sees submitted answers and progress; unsubmitted writing stays private. Preserve first attempts; a retry after an example is assisted.

For remote practice, use the meeting platform's breakout rooms. Assign pairs or trios and rotate agent, buyer, and observer. In pairs, the buyer gives feedback. Every agent needs a speaking turn, one correction, and a retry. If a partner is absent, assign a coach or leave the observation outstanding.

What each signal means

Connection status is separate from participation. A submitted answer is separate from a completed action. A record check is separate from writing quality. Record who observed a speaking turn and who reviewed it; a peer observation or self-check is not coach sign-off. Practice readiness, quiz certification, and activation remain separate.

Facilitator flow

01 / 16 · 0-3 min · Start with practice

Jordan asked for a showing

Have every agent submit an individual response before revealing the model. Compare the main pattern in the room, then demonstrate once. The choice is a warm-up, not proof of skill; the next activity is an observed attempt.

Ask the room: Submit your choice and wording before the example.

Participant task: Jordan asked for a showing. What do you do first?

- Start with budget questions.
- Introduce yourself and offer two showing times.
- Explain the full buying process.
- Write the opening and invitation you would actually use, with your brokerage.

After submission: Introduce yourself and offer two showing times. Help with the request early. A recognizable introduction and showing invitation create the opportunity to meet; financial screening can put a barrier before that meeting. Read the buyer's response and adapt.

Reveal after the first response:

Hi Jordan, I'm Sam with Northside Realty, a featured partner with Zillow. I'm calling about your request to see 1234 Lane. Would Saturday morning or afternoon work better?

02 / 16 · 3-9 min · Start with practice

Try the opening, hear feedback, retry

Reveal the opening example from the previous screen and model it in under a minute. Use five minutes for speaking turns, feedback, and retries. Give every agent a speaking turn, one specific correction, and a targeted retry. Use the meeting platform for breakout rooms. In pairs, the buyer supplies the observation; in trios, rotate agent, buyer, observer. Do not label a peer or self-check as coach sign-off. If no partner is present, assign a coach or leave the observation outstanding. All four introduction details matter: name, brokerage, featured-partner relationship with Zillow, and reason for calling. Offer the meeting early so the buyer can act on their request. An appropriately delayed invitation is a coaching discussion, not automatic failure.

Ask the room: Which specific phrase made the call recognizable and the invitation easy to answer?

Participant task: Speak to your partner. Use the buyer's request and your own brokerage.

- What one correction will you retry?
- What changed in your retry?

Observer criteria:

- Introduces name, brokerage, Zillow featured-partner relationship, and reason for calling
- Offers a relevant appointment early; discusses a delay rather than automatically failing it
- Response fits what the buyer said
- Asks permission and follows the buyer's answer
- Summarizes the buyer's need and the agreed plan

03 / 16 · 9-12 min · Prepare

Call promptly after accepting the lead

This timing comes from the supplied training. Use the team's actual notification workflow. Do not place a duplicate call while someone is already speaking with the buyer.

Ask the room: What would you check before dialing?

04 / 16 · 12-16 min · LEAD

Use LEAD on the first call

Use Eric's LEAD order. An early invitation is the default; respond to an urgent question or the actual situation when needed. Do not insert qualification questions before the invitation.

Ask the room: Say the four letters and what each asks you to do.

Ask permission and listen

Use the buyer's stated preferences. Do not infer family circumstances or steer based on personal characteristics. Practice one follow-up question that uses the buyer's exact words.

Ask the room: What would you ask after "I need a quieter space to work"?

Save financial screening for the right conversation

State the distinction once. Do not teach agents to ignore questions the buyer voluntarily raises. Acknowledge and arrange the appropriate help.

Ask the room: What can you learn without screening the buyer?

Participant task: The first showing invitation does not depend on pre-approval.

- Confirm the showing and ask what interested them.
- Require a down-payment amount before offering a time.
- Collect income and credit details.

After submission: Confirm the showing and ask what interested them. Correct. Help with access, learn what matters, and confirm the plan.

Summarize the buyer's words and the plan

Ask the buyer role to correct one detail. The agent should acknowledge the correction and update the plan. A summary is not an invitation to add a sales pitch.

Ask the room: What would you put into the contact note?

Participant task: Confirm details they can correct.

- Write a summary from your partner's example.

Answer the question honestly

Do not imply a relationship with the listing agent that does not exist. Never hide known property status to obtain an appointment. Ask the room to improve an evasive answer.

Ask the room: What would you say if you do not know the answer?

If the home is under contract

Use truthful status plus a useful next step. Do not promise access, availability, or that a contract will fall through. Let the buyer decide whether alternatives are useful.

Ask the room: Which part answers the question directly?

Participant task: Tell the buyer what you know, then discuss what is still possible.

- Say the update in your own words.

10 / 16 · 31-35 min · Practice

Practice the other invitation responses

Give every agent a speaking turn, one specific correction, and a targeted retry. Use the meeting platform for breakout rooms. In pairs, the buyer supplies the observation; in trios, rotate agent, buyer, observer. Do not label a peer or self-check as coach sign-off. If no partner is present, assign a coach or leave the observation outstanding. Keep the invitation flexible and connected to the buyer's actual response.

Ask the room: Name one specific phrase that helped the buyer.

Participant task: Partners alternate after each attempt.

- What specific correction will you retry?
- What changed in your retry?

Observer criteria:

- Introduces name, brokerage, Zillow featured-partner relationship, and reason for calling
- Offers a relevant appointment early; discusses a delay rather than automatically failing it
- Response fits what the buyer said
- Asks permission and follows the buyer's answer
- Summarizes the buyer's need and the agreed plan

11 / 16 · 35-39 min · Practice

Ask a follow-up that fits the answer

Partners choose a response without telling the agent. The agent asks permission and one follow-up. Ask the buyer whether the question helped them explain their need.

Ask the room: Did you follow the answer, or change the subject?

Participant task: Use a different buyer response each time.

- Write one follow-up for each response.

12 / 16 · 39-55 min · Practice

Run the whole first call

Allow 1 minute for roles. Each round: 3-minute call, 1-minute feedback, 1-minute retry. Rotate three times. If pairs, the buyer gives feedback and both complete a call. Fictional case details are practice material. Give every agent a speaking turn, one specific correction, and a targeted retry. Use the meeting platform for breakout rooms. In pairs, the buyer supplies the observation; in trios, rotate agent, buyer, observer. Do not label a peer or self-check as coach sign-off. If no partner is present, assign a coach or leave the observation outstanding.

Ask the room: Observer: describe what you heard, then request one retry.

Participant task: Agent, buyer, observer. Rotate so everyone makes a call.

- What specific correction will you retry?
- What changed in your retry?

Observer criteria:

- Introduces name, brokerage, Zillow featured-partner relationship, and reason for calling
- Offers a relevant appointment early; discusses a delay rather than automatically failing it
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13 / 16 · 55-58 min · Follow up

If they do not answer

Have each agent leave a 20-second voicemail. Use their actual callback number in real calls. Text is useful for logistics; move detailed property or financing discussion to a call.

Ask the room: Does the message explain who you are and why you called?

14 / 16 · 58-61 min · Follow up

Make at least five personal attempts in the first seven days

This uses Eric's current doctrine. Remove the original implication that later effort is wasted. Ask an agent to distinguish an automated touch from a personal attempt. Do not invent a new cadence beyond the first week.

Ask the room: Which attempts would you count in a contact history?

15 / 16 · 61-64 min · Retain

Explain LEAD without looking back

Allow 45 seconds without notes. Ask a partner to identify one missing detail. Have the agent redo that part aloud.

Ask the room: Where does the showing invitation belong?

Participant task: Write first. Compare with a partner. Then check.

- What happens at L, E, A, and D?

Reveal after the first response:

Lead with who you are. Extend the invitation early. Ask permission and listen. Deliver a summary and confirm the plan.

16 / 16 · 64-67 min · Retain

Before your next client conversation

In live sessions, closing the session creates 24-hour recall, three-day fresh-case, and seven-day coach-review assignments. Confirm each agent's named coach and session timezone. Agents see due work in Rep; the daily digest links to due or reviewable work. In self-paced study, arrange these checks with a coach. Without a relevant client opportunity, use a fresh fictional case and label real-work application not yet observed. Practice readiness is separate from quiz certification and activation.

Ask the room: Tell your partner what you will practice and when.

Participant task: Write down when you will practice again.

- My practice partner, time, and focus

Buyer practice cards

Jordan • weekend showing

"I asked about Lane because I need a quieter space to work. Saturday morning might work."

Buyer: ask whether the agent is the listing agent. Agent: use LEAD and answer honestly.

Morgan • property question

"Before I book anything, do you know how old the roof is?"

Buyer: accept another time if the first two do not work. Agent: say what you know, capture what needs checking, and offer a visit.

Alex • home unavailable

"I only called about that one home. Is it still available?"

Practice fact: the home is under contract. Tell the buyer promptly and ask whether similar homes would help.

After the workshop

Live session: closing the session creates assignments for recall within 24 hours, a fresh case in three days, and coach review in seven days. The session creator owns follow-up across the selected teams unless a different authorized coach was selected. Confirm the displayed session timezone. Due and overdue work appears in Rep; the daily digest links to work due or awaiting review.

Self-paced study: arrange those same checks with a coach. If there has been no relevant client opportunity, use a new fictional case and mark real-work application as not yet observed.

Keep the first attempt and correction. A useful follow-up asks whether the agent can apply the skill in another case.

References and certification

Updated September 12, 2026 from the existing Day 2 workshop and Eric's approved interactive-training plan. TRU sales doctrine remains the source for coaching the first call and follow-up.

- Your coach and approved team workflow.

Existing quizzes, pass thresholds, and certification records continue through the normal Rep course flow. The presentation link is not a certification attempt.